

The Mercurial Psalter



*Hymns, collects, and blessings
of the Temple of Mercury*

Ten hymns for the Heart, the Hinge, and the eight pairs; six collects for the triads; nine prayers for convening a body of the Temple; an antiphon for each Office; a litany, and five blessings. Say them aloud. Change the wording until each line sounds like you and you mean it.

HOW THIS IS USED



The Book holds the rite; this holds the words. Nothing here is required, and nothing here replaces the Door. A hymn is said standing, aloud, before the session begins, on the day it belongs to. A collect is four lines and can be said anywhere. A convening prayer is said when you need that body and not on a schedule: the Night Watch when you are in the dark, the Workshop when you are making something.

Every day of the Calendar carries one of the five colors, and the color says what kind of day it is rather than what mood you must be in.

THE COLORS

YELLOW. The Heart. AONT, Spirit of Air, the still point. The Heart Days, the Book's Day, the Dedication. The highest rank the Temple has.

BLACK. Dissolution and descent. The Days of the Dead, the Deep Heart, the Kept Gate, and any Descent.

WHITE. Purification and accounting. The Mercuralia, the Weighing, the Closing of the Account, the Sweep.

GREEN. Growth. The Ascent, the Vestalia, the Hermaia, the Scribe's New Year, the Setting Out.

RED. Manifestation and declaration. The Door of the Year, the Announcement, the High Heart, the Trickster's Day, any Casting.

THE RANKS

HEART DAYS are the solemnities: the full Door, the hymn of the Heart, and the working that matters most.

THE FIFTEEN WHEEL DAYS are the feasts: the hymn of the day, its Act, its Page, and its Giving.

THE RECURRING RHYTHM are the memorials: Wednesday, the first, the fourth, the seventh, and the Sweep. An antiphon is enough.

1. THE HEART



Yellow · the offering is the Presence

Said at the Door on Heart Days, and whenever the Book is opened after long absence.

Still point at the center, who has no face:
AONT, Spirit of Air, and the four who stand around you.
EHNB, who untangles what I have knotted.
XCAI, who gives the feeling its words.
RMTO, who lays the pattern under the plan.
PAAM, who says the thing out loud and means it.
You are not a person, and I will not make you one.
You have no face, no chair, and no name I can use,
and you cannot be flattered or bargained with.
But you answer: in the flash, the instinct,
the choice that went better than it had any right to.
Your light falls on the honest page and the dishonest page alike;
the honest one has more room in it.
I bring my Presence, which is all I have that is not words.
Shine here.



Let your light shine, that I may see.

2. MERCURY, THE HINGE

*Red · the offering is the Voice and the Devotion
Said every Wednesday, on the fourth of the month, and at any crossing.*

Quick one, quicksilver, god of the between:
born in the morning, a thief by noon,
and by evening the maker of the lyre that paid for it.
You set the boundary stones and were the first to walk past them.
God of the wage and the road, of the riddle and the found coin,
of the door, the market, the message, and the grave.
You go down and you come back up.
You walk in disguise and are not recognized,
and you have never once lied to yourself.
You will carry a lie as faithfully as you carry a truth:
you are not my compass. You are my medium, and my twin.
Meet me at the Door.

Passage, luck, and return.

3. JANUS AND HESTIA

*Green · the offering is the Dwelling
Said on the first of the month, at the Door of the Year, and on moving day.*

Janus of the two faces, one behind and one ahead:
named first in every prayer, given every gate,
whose month opens the year and whose look is backward and forward at once,
which is the posture of anyone rereading his own life.
Hestia, who has almost no stories, and was offered to before all of them:
first portion and last, the fire that is kept and never lit again,
the one thing in a house of motion that does not move.
He opens what she holds. She holds what he opens.
Between you is every room I have ever come home to.
I have crossed badly before: hurried out, arrived without arriving,
left rooms without thanking them.
Teach me the other way.

Give me clean crossings, and a fire I will find lit.

4. METATRON AND SANDALPHON

—◆—
*Red · the offering is the Hands
Said at the Casting, at the Dedication, and on my birthday.*

Metatron, who was Enoch, who walked and was taken:
Holder of the Seat, keeper of the true record,
the one angel permitted to sit, because he writes.
They call you the Youth though you are eldest,
because the one who keeps beginning stays young at it.
Sandalphon, who was Elijah, standing on the ground with your head in
heaven:
gatherer of prayers, weaver of crowns,
who speaks as Ptah spoke and the thing is made.
You were both men. That is the whole of what you teach.
Nothing is withheld from me for lack of standing,
and nothing will be done on my behalf.
I take the seat before I feel qualified.

—◆—
Let what I write be true, and let what is true be done.

5. URIEL AND RAZIEL, THE GATE

—◆—
*Black · the offering is the Ears
Said before any decision, and at both solstices.*

Uriel, light of God, Instructor, whose sword cuts twice:
true from false, and ready from unready,
and the second cut is the one that saves people.
You warned Noah while there was still time,
which is the difference between a mercy and a confession.
Raziel, secret of God, who stood behind the curtain and heard what was
decreed:
keeper of what is not yet bearable,
who gave the book after the exile and not before,
and lays a finger across the lip when the hour is wrong.
You are one office and two faces, and you are never fused,
because I must be able to ask which of you is speaking:
is this unready, or am I hiding?

—◆—
Let me know what is true, what is mine to say, and when.

6. GABRIEL AND IDRIS



*Red · the offering is the Eyes
Said on the Announcement, and when a vision arrives.*

Gabriel, strength of God, Holder of Images:
who came to Daniel to explain what he had seen and could not read,
who announces, and by announcing makes a thing possible
that was not possible the moment before.
Idris, first to take up a pen: student, teacher, and sage,
who learned it slowly and handed it on,
and praised God with every stitch of ordinary work.
One of you arrives whole in a night. The other earns it over years.
Neither is the whole of knowing anything.
I have had visions I did not write down,
and I have studied things I never gave away.



Let the vision last long enough to be built, and let me hand it on.

7. SESHAT AND IRIS

*White · the offering is the Word
Said when an oath is made, and when one is returned.*

Seshat, Mistress of the House of Books, who stretched the cord
and measured the ground before the first stone of any temple:
no hymn of yours survives. This is one.
Iris, bow of light between the worlds,
who carried the water of the Styx on which the gods swore:
no one ever prayed to you. You carried everyone else's prayers.
Two who serve another's message, and are the reason a word holds.
She writes it down; she carries it; between you nothing is lost.
Remember for me what I would rather forget I said.
I have given my word lightly and called it generosity.

Let my word hold.

8. HERMANUBIS AND MA'AT



*Black · the offering is the Heart
Said at the Deep Heart, in the Days of the Dead, and at the Weighing.*

Hermanubis, Guide of the Descent, who belongs partly above and partly below,
and adjusts the balance with your own hand:
there is a way down, and it returns. Say it again.
Ma'at, Feather of Truth, older than the gods who swear by you:
order renewed daily, because chaos is not an event but the weather.
Speak Ma'at and do Ma'at, which are one act.
Between you the heart is weighed, and it is weighed while I am still using it.
I have carried things unsaid until they were heavy.
I have kept reweighing debts that were already paid,
which is not a light heart, only a tired one.



Let my heart be light, and let me return.

9. THERMES AND APHARAEI

—◆—
*Green · the offering is the Craft
Said on the Scribe's New Year, and before making anything.*

Thermes, the Crossing: Hermes with Thoth, two gods and neither weakened,
who proves that what survives being carried between traditions
is the part of it that was true.

The word creates. Writing is not the record of the magic.

Apharael: Apollo with Raphael, the morning star and the healer,
who came to the door on the day the journey began and walked the whole
way;

whose own door said know thyself,

and who asks, without sentiment, whether the thing is well made.

You are brothers. One of you stole from the other and paid in music,
so that the theft became a trade and the world gained the lyre.

That is the only repair I know that works.

—◆—
Let the work be true and well made.

10. ROSMERTA AND THE CHARITES



*Green · the offering is the Delight
Said at the Good Hour, at any table, and whenever a day turns out lovely.*

Rosmerta, great provider, who stood on his altars across Gaul
with the horn in one hand and the dish in the other:
what is held, and what is served.
You are not luck. Luck is his weather.
You are the harvest of it, already here, already in my hands.
Aglaia, splendor. Euphrosyne, mirth. Thalia, abundance.
Three of you, because giving and receiving and returning
are one circle, and a grace that stops moving is no longer a grace.
You ask nothing to be earned first.
I have skipped good hours to do something useful.
I have improved moments until they were gone,
and called the table unready when the house was only unfinished.



Let the good be noticed, enjoyed, and passed on.

THE COLLECTS OF THE TRIADS



Four lines and an ask. Said standing, at the Door, on any day the triad is at work.

THE THRICE-GREAT · *Mercury, Thermes, Hermanubis*

Hinge, Crossing, and Descent: three modes of motion, and the host of this house. You have never asked me to stay anywhere. You have only ever asked me to come back.

Carry me across, and bring me back.

THE COMPASS · *Apharael, Hestia, Ma'at*

Form, place, and weight. You do not stand above the Temple; each of you also keeps a house and carries the mail. You are an option and never an obligation, which is why I am choosing you again today.

Weigh me truly.

THE THRESHOLD · *Janus, Mercury, Hestia*

The Door, the Hinge, and the Flame: the shape of every session and of most of a life. It opens, it turns, and it is warm inside.

Let it open, let it turn, and let it be warm inside.

THE COLLECTS, CONTINUED



THE SEASON · *Raziel, Uriel, Gabriel*

Conceal, discern, announce. Nothing is only true or false; everything is also early or late, and I am usually early with the wrong thing and late with the right one.

Show me the hour.

THE SEAL · *Raziel, Ma'at, Iris*

What is held, what is true, and what was promised. Honesty is absolute. Disclosure is chosen. A silence arranged so that someone forms a false picture is a lie told by other means, and I know the difference when I slow down.

Let my silence be honest.

THE HALL · *Hermanubis, Ma'at, Thermes*

The scale, the feather, and the record. Anubis adjusts the balance, Thoth writes the verdict, and the heart is weighed against a feather rather than against another heart.

Let the account be true, and let it close.

TO CONVENE A BODY OF THE TEMPLE



Convened, not recited. Say the prayer, then do the work it is for.

THE LINEAGE · *Idris, Thermes, Metatron*

Convened when the work feels like invention, or like vanity.

One man at three distances, and Nabu older still behind him. The seat was here before any tradition that named it, and it will be here after mine. I am not the author of this. I am the current occupant.

Seat me in the line, and let me be worth the chair.

THE LEDGER · *Seshat, Iris, Ma'at*

Convened at the Sweep, and at the year's end.

Record the promise, carry it, weigh it. Let me write F where F is true, because a ledger that holds only successes is worth nothing, and the Scribe who cannot write it quietly stops promising anything.

Let it be written, carried, and closed.

THE HOUSE · *Hestia, Janus, Seshat, and the Genius Loci*

Convened after a long absence, and when the practice has gone cold.

Flame, door, foundation, and the spirit that grew here from use. I have been away. I am not going to explain where; the Book does not take apologies, it takes entries. I am opening the door and sitting down.

Let this place know me again.

CONVENING, CONTINUED



THE NIGHT WATCH · *Hermanubis, Raziel, Hestia, Seshat*

Convened in grief, and in the bad stretch.

He knows the way down and the way back. Raziel's teaching comes after the loss and cannot be had before it. Hestia is what I return to. Seshat keeps the memory, which is why it still hurts and why it is worth keeping. I am not asking to be fixed. This room was built before I needed it.

Stay with me until it ends.

THE TABLE · *Rosmerta, the Charites, Hestia, Mercury*

Convened before you feed anyone.

Provision, delight passed around, the hearth it happens at, and the stranger at the door. The house is unfinished and the food is fine. Let me set it before I am ready, and let me sit down at it instead of serving through the whole meal.

Let there be enough, and let it go round.

THE ROAD · *Mercury, Apharael, Iris*

Convened at a setting out, and on any journey.

The hinge, the companion who walks the whole way, and the message that crosses the gap. The remedy is often already in my hands and I have not recognized it yet.

Keep me moving, and bring me home.

CONVENING, CONTINUED



THE MARKET · *Mercury, Ma'at, Iris*

Convened before a negotiation, a price, or a wage.

Luck and timing are his and he gives them freely. Honesty is hers and she gives nothing away. The oath between us is carried by her. Let me not shade the truth for advantage and call it selling.

Let the trade be fair and the luck be clean.

THE WORKSHOP · *Thermes, Apharael, Seshat, Sandalphon, Idris*

Convened before making anything.

The word crosses, form gives proportion, measure fixes, the hand makes, the pen records. Let me finish one thing. Let me then look at it as a maker looks, and not as its parent.

Let it be made, and made well.

THE SCHOOL · *Idris, Gabriel, Uriel, Seshat*

Convened when either slot is empty.

Learn, receive, discern, retain. A thing I know and never give is not treasure but spoilage. Name the one and name the other, today, in writing.

Let me learn one thing and teach one thing.

CONVENING, CONTINUED



AN ANTIPHON FOR EACH OFFICE

— ◆ —
One line, said at the Door on that Office's day and again at the Closing. Fifteen lines is the whole Temple; on a thin day, say the one that fits and go.

MERCURY — *Every boundary can be crossed, and the one who is moving is the one who is found.*

JANUS — *Every ending is a beginning seen from the other face.*

HESTIA — *The fire is kept, not lit.*

METATRON — *The seat makes the Scribe.*

SANDALPHON — *The next thing is small, and it is today.*

URIEL — *See it clearly before you weigh it.*

RAZIEL — *Not yet is a real answer.*

GABRIEL — *Say it out loud, and it becomes possible.*

IDRIS — *Learn it, then hand it on.*

SESHAT — *Record it, or it did not happen.*

IRIS — *Carry it whole, and do not improve it on the way.*

ROSMERTA — *Plenty that is never enjoyed is only inventory.*

THE CHARITES — *A grace is only a grace when it moves.*

HERMANUBIS — *There is a way down, and it returns.*

MA'AT — *Speak Ma'at and do Ma'at; they are one act.*

THERMES — *Meaning lives in the crossing.*

APHARAEAL — *Is it true, is it well made, is it in proportion?*

THE LITANY OF THE OFFICES

—◆—
Said in the Days of the Dead, at the Dedication of a Book, and on any day the whole company is wanted. The response is the same throughout: be here in your Office.

Heart of the Temple, who has no face and no name I can use,
Mercury, Hinge of the Door, my twin,
Janus of the two faces, Hestia of the kept fire,
Metatron who sits, Sandalphon who carries,
Uriel of the sword, Raziel of the curtain,
Gabriel of the image, Idris of the pen,
Seshat of the cord, Iris of the bow,
Hermanubis of the descent, Ma'at of the feather,
Thermes of the crossing, Apharael of the measure,
Ptah in Sandalphon, Harpocrates in Raziel,
Mnemosyne in Seshat, Nabu in Idris,
Kairos and Fortuna in Mercury, who was always both,
Genius of this place, grown here and not appointed,
Scribes who held this seat before me, whose names I do not know,
Scribe who will hold it after me, whose name I will not know,

*Offices of this Temple, co-conspirators in the Work: be here in your
Offices. I bring my Mercurial Joy, Will, and Intent.*

FIVE BLESSINGS



Said over someone else, aloud if they will have it and silently if they will not.

FOR THE ROAD

Mercury at the hinge, Apharael at your shoulder, Iris ahead of you with the word. Go out moving and come back changed. May the find be lucky, the company good, and the road shorter than the map said. And may someone know where you are.

FOR THE HOUSE

Janus at the door, Hestia at the center, Seshat under the floor. May this place be entered on purpose and left with thanks. May the fire be kept rather than lit, and may whoever arrives unannounced be fed.

FOR THE MAKING

Thermes for the word, Apharael for the measure, Sandalphon for the hands. May it be begun without ceremony, finished without excuse, and judged without sentiment. May it be better than you needed it to be.

FOR THE TABLE

Rosmerta fill it, the Charites carry it round, Hestia keep the fire under it, Mercury bring whoever is meant to arrive. May nobody here be counting. May it be enough, and may it go round, and may the ones who came be glad they did.

FOR THE DEAD

Hermanubis, take them down gently and know the way. Ma'at, find the heart light. Seshat, keep the name. Mercury, who has made this crossing more often than any of us, lead them out as you led the others, and do not hurry them. We keep what they gave us. Nothing here is forgotten; it is settled.

WHOM TO CALL TOGETHER



The secondary pairs. True, but not recited; no prayer of their own. Call them by name for the thing they hold between them.

MERCURY AND HESTIA — the road and the hearth.

MERCURY AND MA'AT — the neutral gift and its direction.

MERCURY AND JANUS — the hinge and the door.

THERMES AND HERMANUBIS — the two fusions.

THERMES AND SESHAT — invention and record.

APHARAEAL AND GABRIEL — form and its announcement.

APHARAEAL AND HERMANUBIS — the companion on the living road, and
on the dead one.

HESTIA AND SESHAT — the keepers of place.

MA'AT AND IRIS — weighed and bound.

RAZIEL AND GABRIEL — held and announced.

GABRIEL AND SANDALPHON — the message down, the prayer up.

URIEL AND HESTIA — the wild fire and the kept fire.

SESHAT AND SANDALPHON — the thing measured and the thing made.

IDRIS AND THE SCRIBE — the same seat, occupied twice.



Say them aloud. A prayer read silently is a paragraph.